

Incident Escalation Policy

Owner: Site Reliability Engineering. Reviewed quarterly. This policy applies to all production-facing services.

Severity definitions

Severity	Definition	Page	Status page	Postmortem
P1	Total outage or customer data risk	Immediately	Within 15 min	Required
P2	Significant degradation, partial outage	Within 15 min	Within 30 min	Required
P3	Minor degradation, single feature	Business hours	Not required	Optional
P4	Cosmetic, no customer impact	Business hours	Not required	Not required

On-call chain

Primary on-call carries the page. If no acknowledgement within 8 minutes, the secondary is paged automatically. If secondary does not ack within 8 more minutes, the engineering manager on call is paged.

When to wake the engineering manager

Wake the EM on call for: any P1 lasting more than 30 minutes; any incident where customer data confidentiality, integrity, or availability is at risk; any incident involving payment processing.

Communications policy

All P1/P2 incidents require updates in the #incident channel every 15 minutes. Updates must include: current status, actions taken, ETA to next action, customer impact estimate. Updates may be brief but must not be skipped.

Anti-patterns

- Paging the entire team instead of escalating up the chain.
- Silently waiting for the primary to ack past the 8-minute window.
- Updating the status page without telling the IC.
- Resolving the incident in monitoring before customer impact is confirmed mitigated.